



NCL Prima — Solo Cruisers Group

September 27 – October 4, 2026 · Tina Maulsby, host

Ship: Norwegian Prima · **Sailing from:** Port Canaveral · **Cabin:** _____

A condensed Voyage Pack from [In the Wake](#) — the essentials in three pages. The full pack covers cabins, packing, budget, ship orientation, ports in depth, NCL's quirks, and the group rhythm.

Day by day

#	Date	Port	Hours ashore	Tender	Worth knowing
1	Sun Sep 27	Port Canaveral — embarkation	board 12:00 – 3:30 PM; depart 4:00 PM	—	All-aboard 3 PM. Sailaway at the Penrose Atrium with Tina.
2	Mon Sep 28	Great Stirrup Cay (NCL private)	~8:00 AM – 5:00 PM	no (pier)	NCL's Bahamian private island; docks at the new two-berth pier, one of the first sailings since its second berth opened; no tendering unless weather closes it. Beach + buffet free. Great Tides Waterpark is new: myNCL pre-booking closes two days before sailing, so buy the pass at the Shore Excursion Desk as soon as you board (NCL says onboard passes are limited and may sell out).
3	Tue Sep 29	Cruising at sea	—	—	First sea day, the long leg south. Studio coffee hour; specialty dining bookings.
4	Wed Sep 30	Falmouth, Jamaica	~7:00 AM – 4:00 PM	dock	Greenwood Great House + Historic Falmouth walk (closer + culture-heavy), or Dunn's River Falls (about an hour's drive each way).
5	Thu Oct 1	Grand Cayman	~7:00 AM – 3:30 PM	tender	Stingray City sandbar (~\$60 indep) or 7-Mile Beach (~\$5 #1 bus).
6	Fri Oct 2	Cozumel, Mexico	~9:30 AM – 5:30 PM	dock	Palancar Reef snorkel (~\$50 indep / ~\$95 ship). The Western Caribbean dive.
7	Sat Oct 3	Cruising at sea	—	—	Closing sea day, north through the Yucatán Channel. Bags out tonight; last Hudson's dinner.
8	Sun Oct 4	Port Canaveral — debarkation	alongside ~7:00 AM; off by 10:00 AM	—	Orlando MCO ~45 min Uber (\$60–80).

Hudson's 5:30 PM nightly — Tina's standard group dinner; show up to whichever nights work. Free with your fare.

One tender port — Grand Cayman. Plan 20–30 min end-to-end at peak. Great Stirrup Cay is a pier call for this sailing; tendering returns there only if weather closes the pier.

⚠ **Peak hurricane season.** Sep 27 – Oct 4 sits on the back half of the season's peak (the National Hurricane Center puts the top of it at Sep 10, with most activity mid-August to mid-October). Itinerary changes (port swaps, skips, rerouting) are common. **Travel insurance with hurricane coverage is strongly recommended.** The ship is safe; you're just more likely to lose a port than to lose the cruise.

Currency aboard: USD. **Auto-gratuity:** \$20/day per person at most cabins; \$25/day Suites/Haven.

Decide before you board. Run the [drink-calculator](#) on your real drinking pattern, the [budget-calculator](#) for the total-fare picture, and the [tipping-calculator](#) for auto-grats + cash tips — mid-sail upgrades cost more per day and give you fewer days of usage. Tina can confirm what's bundled in your Free at Sea.

Getting to the ship — and getting home

Arrival: Saturday recommended, Sunday required

Saturday Sep 26 — fly in. Same-day Sunday flights to a 3:30 PM all-aboard leave no margin for September-afternoon Florida thunderstorms. Hotel options:

- **Cocoa Beach** (15 min from port) — beach-town energy, walking distance to pier and beach. Simpler hotels but the right location if you want to be near the port.
- **Orlando MCO area** (45 min from port) — more hotel options, more variety, longer Sunday-morning transfer.

Sunday Sep 27 — embarkation.

- **Terminal: Port Canaveral, Cruise Terminal 5** per the Port Authority’s 2026 master schedule (return Oct 4 is listed at Terminal 6). Confirm in the NCL app.
- **MCO → Port Canaveral:** Uber/Lyft \$60–80, 45–60 min. Shared cruise shuttle ~\$30/person.
- **If driving:** Port Canaveral garage ~\$17–22/day; reservable in advance.
- **Embark window:** 12:00 – 3:30 PM. **All-aboard 3:00 PM.** NCL lists a 4:00 PM departure; the Port Authority schedule shows 6:00 PM. Be aboard an hour before whatever your cruise documents say.
- **NCL app online check-in** before arrival.

Day 8 debark and the trip home

- **The night before:** bags in the hall by ~11 PM with color-coded tag.
- **5:30 – 7:00 AM:** Breakfast at Indulge Food Hall or Surfside Café.
- **~7:00 AM:** Ship alongside (Terminal 6 per the port schedule); self-disembarkation begins once cleared.
- **7:00 – 9:30 AM:** Walk-off in waves. All passengers off by 10:00 AM.

Carry-on with you: change of clothes, all medications, passport, phone charger, valuables.

Getting from Port Canaveral to MCO. Uber/Lyft on Sunday morning, **\$60–80, 45–60 min.** Surge pricing possible.

Killing 4–6 hours before an evening flight:

- **Cocoa Beach pier** — 15-min Uber. Beach walk + casual lunch.
- **Kennedy Space Center** — 20-min Uber, \$77 adult entry in 2026. Half-day minimum if done properly.
- **Cocoa Village** — historic small-town main street; lunch + shops.

Airport-arrival timing for MCO (45+ min away).

Flight	Leave Port Canaveral by
Domestic, after 4 PM	12:30 PM
International, after 6 PM	2:00 PM

Areas of interest during the cruise

On the ship — Prima spots worth knowing

- **The Penrose Atrium** — three-deck central social space; orienting landmark and Tina's likely sailaway venue.
- **Ocean Boulevard** (Deck 8) — outdoor wraparound walkway at sea level. Sunrise coffee and sailaway viewing.
- **Indulge Food Hall** — 11 quick-casual concepts under one roof; included. The right call when you don't want to commit to a sit-down meal.
- **Studio Lounge** (solo-cabin perk) — hosted coffee hour on the first sea-day morning (Day 3) typically; the daily social anchor.
- **The Rush** — dueling dry racing slides (10-story drop) in the three-deck Aqua Park. Race a friend. First hour after opening has zero line.
- **The Drop** — the world's first freefall dry slide at sea, alongside The Rush. Adult-rated.
- **Vibe Beach Club** — adults-only enclave; priced per sailing in myNCL, about \$250–300 for a 7-night in 2026 reports. Quietest pool on Prima.
- **Mandara Spa thermal-suite day pass** — sea-day intro rates appear.

Sea-day priorities (Day 3 + Day 7)

1. **Sunrise on Ocean Boulevard** — best 30 minutes of the week.
2. **Studio meet-and-greet** Day 1 + Studio Lounge coffee hour Day 3 — NCL hosts both.
3. **The Rush** dry racing slides first hour after opening.
4. **Thermal suite at Mandara Spa** — sea-day morning intro rate.
5. **Specialty dining reservation** for Day 3 or Day 7 evening — Onda by Scarpetta, Le Bistro, Cagney's fill fast.

Specialty dining picks

- **Onda by Scarpetta** — modern Italian, Scott Conant partnership; the most refined meal.
- **Le Bistro** — French; the most romantic specialty room.
- **Cagney's Steakhouse** — NCL's reliable steakhouse standard.
- **Hasuki** — Japanese teppanyaki (the showy hibachi room).
- **Los Lobos** — modern Mexican.

Port-day picks (one each)

- **Great Stirrup Cay** — beach + buffet day; rent snorkel gear if visibility looks good. Cabana upgrade \$250–400.
- **Falmouth** — Greenwood Great House (Caribbean colonial history, ~\$60–80) is closer and more interesting than Dunn's River Falls (about an hour each way). Or a beach club for a low-stress day.
- **Grand Cayman** — Stingray City sandbar (~\$60 indep / \$90 ship) is the iconic. Or 7-Mile Beach via \$5 #1 bus for the easy day.
- **Cozumel** — Palancar Reef snorkel tour (~\$50 indep / ~\$95 ship). Two hours, calm water, the conversion experience.

Where Tina sets the rhythm

- **Day 1 sailaway** — likely Penrose Atrium around 3:30 PM. Watch her communications.
- **Hudson's 5:30 PM nightly** — recurring group dinner.
- **Studio Lounge** — solo cruisers cluster here regardless of who's hosting.
- **Tina may book** a specialty group dinner mid-week (Onda, Le Bistro, or Cagney's).

Photo spots worth knowing

- **Sailaway from Ocean Boulevard Deck 8** — Cape Canaveral coastline at golden hour.
- **The Penrose Atrium** at evening — three-deck atmospheric light.
- **Great Stirrup Cay lighthouse** at the south end.
- **Stingray City sandbar** — bring an underwater camera for the in-water shots.
- **Palancar Reef** from the snorkel boat — underwater shots worth saving.

Need an at-home emergency handoff card? Separate one-page doc — ask Tina or download from [In the Wake](#). The full Voyage Pack is the unabridged companion document. Soli Deo Gloria.